developed by Christopher Fuchs, Rüdiger Schack, Carlton Caves, N. David Mermin, and others. These days the label is typically shortened to QBism and pronounced “cubism.” (One must admit it’s a charming name.)

Bayesian inference suggests that we all carry around with us a set of credences for various propositions to be true or false, and update those credences when new information comes in. All versions of quantum mechanics (and indeed all scientific theories) use Bayes’s theorem in some version or another, and in many approaches to understanding quantum probability it plays a crucial role. QBism is distinguished by making our quantum credences *personal*, rather than universal. According to QBism, the wave function of an electron isn’t a once-and-for-all thing that everyone could, in principle, agree on. Rather, everyone has their own idea of what the electron’s wave function is, and uses that idea to make predictions about observational outcomes. If we do many experiments and talk to one another about what we’ve observed, QBists claim, we will come to a degree of consensus about what the various wave functions are. But they are fundamentally measures of our personal belief, not objective features of the world. When we see an electron deflected upward in a Stern-Gerlach magnetic field, the world doesn’t change, but we’ve learned something new about it.

There is one immediate and undeniable advantage of such a philosophy: if the wave function isn’t a physical thing, there’s no need to fret about it “collapsing,” even if that collapse is purportedly nonlocal. If Alice and Bob possess two particles that are entangled with each other and Alice makes a measurement, according to the ordinary rules of quantum mechanics the state of Bob’s particle changes instantaneously. QBism reassures us that we needn’t worry about that, as there is no such thing as “the state of Bob’s particle.” What changed was the wave function that Alice carries around with her to make predictions: it was updated using a suitably quantum version of Bayes’s theorem. Bob’s wave function didn’t change at all. QBism arranges the rules of the game so that when Bob does get around to measuring his particle, the outcome will agree with the prediction we would make on the basis of Alice’s measurement outcome. But there is no need along the way to imagine that any physical quantity changed over at Bob’s location. All that changes are different people’s states of knowledge, which after all are localized in their heads, not spread through all space.